PhotoMatrix

Web Admin Guide

Importing Photos from a URL

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Use the admin Import tab to scan a portfolio page, select images, and create photo records. Scan and import are admin-only API operations. A scan may not find every image on a site, and availability depends on the source page and image URLs.

1. Open Import

1. Sign in as an administrator and open Manage at /manage.
2. Choose the Import tab inside Manage.

Import is not a top-level site-navigation link. The import UI calls the admin-only API routes POST /api/admins/import-from-url/scan, GET /api/admins/import-from-url/proxy for image previews, and POST /api/admins/import-from-url/import.

2. Enter a URL and Choose Storage

In Import Photos from URL, enter a portfolio page URL in Portfolio URL, then choose Storage mode:

- **Download & store** downloads each selected image and stores a copy in PhotoMatrix storage. The source is still needed for scanning and fetching the image during import; a failed image fetch can fail that image's import.
- **Link only** creates a record using the source image URL rather than downloading a copy. The source must continue serving the image for it to remain available.

Click Scan for Photos. The scan attempts to retrieve the page and discover candidate images; pages requiring a login, JavaScript rendering, or special access may not produce usable results. A successful scan can include a guessed photographer name, biography text, image URLs, and alt text where available. These are suggestions, not verified metadata.

3. Select Photos

The Select Photos step shows a preview grid. The UI selects all discovered images initially.

- Click a thumbnail or its checkbox to select or deselect it.
- Use Select All or Deselect All to change the selection.
- The count shows how many of the scanned images are selected.
- The text shown on a thumbnail comes from its available alt text, or Untitled when none is available; it is not necessarily the final photo title.

Click Next: Assign & Import (N photos) to continue. This button is disabled if no images are selected. Back returns to the URL step.

4. Assign Photographer, Club, and Photo Details

The next step is Assign & Import. The page says how many photos are selected.

Photographer

Choose + Add new photographer or an existing photographer. For a new profile, the New Photographer Name is required by the UI before import; the name and optional Bio are prefilled from scan results when available. If you select an existing profile, its existing profile is used instead.

Club (optional)

Club is explicitly optional. Choose No club to leave imported photos without a club, an existing club to assign one, or + Add new club and enter a name. A new photographer is associated with the selected club when a club is chosen.

Per-photo title and theme

Each selected photo has an editable title field and a theme selector. The UI also offers an Apply theme to all selector.

- The title starts with the image alt text when usable. Blank, generic, or filename-like titles may be replaced with a generated Photo import #N title.

- Blank or filename-like titles receive an amber warning. This is a warning, not a hard import requirement: the current Import button enablement checks selection, pending state, a new photographer's name, and a new club's name; it does not require a manually entered title. The API also falls back to a title derived from the image URL if the submitted title is blank.
- Theme is optional; No theme is available. The UI notes that unthemed imports may receive an AI theme suggestion after import. AI analysis is asynchronous, so do not treat a suggestion as a guaranteed import result.

Click Import N photos. The button changes to an importing state while the request is in progress.

5. Review the Result

The Import Complete view reports the number imported successfully and, when applicable, the number that failed. The API processes images individually, so a response may contain both successful and failed items. It does not promise that every selected image will import.

Click Import More to reset the form and start another scan.

6. API and Practical Notes

- The scan, preview proxy, and import routes require admin access. The import request accepts image URLs and optional photographer, club, theme, and link-only settings. The UI sends per-photo title and theme values; club assignment is optional.
- With Download & store, the API fetches each image and creates a storage copy. With Link only, it records the source URL. Fetch failures and non-image or unusably small responses can cause individual failures.
- The API returns imported and failed counts. Since imports are not guaranteed to succeed as a whole, check the result before deciding whether to retry. The interface does not identify failed items individually for selective retry.
- The import flow does not provide a guarantee of duplicate detection. Check the gallery before importing the same portfolio again.

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